

Phonological Awareness

Teacher Copy · Oral · ~8 min

SKILL 1/11

Student: _____

Grade: _____

Date: _____

Read each prompt in italics exactly as written. All oral — student never sees this sheet.

1 Rhyme Recognition

Say: "I'm going to say two words. Do they rhyme — yes or no?"

Word	Expected	✓ / ✗
cat / hat	-> YES	✓ ✗
dog / sun	-> NO	✓ ✗
pin / win	-> YES	✓ ✗

Misses either -> Phonological Awareness is the starting point. Do not move to phonics yet.

2 Rhyme Production

Say: "Tell me any word that rhymes with _____. A silly word is fine!"

Word	Expected	✓ / ✗
cat	-> any -at word	✓ ✗
hop	-> any -op word	✓ ✗
sun	-> any -un word	✓ ✗

Can't produce rhymes -> onset-rime awareness needs direct instruction before phonics.

3 Syllable Segmentation

Say: "Clap the parts in this word and tell me how many."

Word	Expected	✓ / ✗
rainbow	-> 2	✓ ✗
elephant	-> 3	✓ ✗
cat	-> 1	✓ ✗

Misses syllables -> syllable awareness needs work. Try compound words first (rain-bow).

4 Onset-Rime Blending

Say: "I'll say a word in two parts — you put them together. /c/ ... /at/ = ?"

Word	Expected	✓ / ✗
/s/ + /un/	-> sun	✓ ✗
/m/ + /oon/	-> moon	✓ ✗
/f/ + /ag/	-> flag	✓ ✗

Can't blend onset-rime -> move back to rhyme work before phoneme-level tasks.

5 Phoneme Blending

Say: "I'll say each sound separately — you blend them into a word."

Word	Expected	✓ / ✗
/s/ /a/ /t/	-> sat	✓ ✗
/f/ /i/ /sh/	-> fish	✓ ✗
/s/ /t/ /o/ /p/	-> stop	✓ ✗

Can't blend phonemes -> Hegarty blending level not yet mastered. Target before segmenting.

6 Phoneme Segmentation

Say: "Tap your finger for each sound you hear in this word."

Word	Expected	✓ / ✗
sun	-> /s/u/n/ — 3	✓ ✗
ship	-> /sh/i/p/ — 3	✓ ✗
flag	-> /f/l/a/g/ — 4	✓ ✗

Can't segment -> critical gap. Segmenting is the foundation of spelling. Prioritize this.

7 Phoneme Deletion

Say: "Say the word — now say it without that sound. What's left?"

Word	Expected	✓ / ✗
smash (no /s/)	-> mash	✓ ✗
flag (no /f/)	-> lag	✓ ✗
trip (no /t/)	-> rip	✓ ✗

Can't delete -> phoneme manipulation not yet developed. Solidify blending and segmenting first.

Notes